SAFE-EX
UTILITY EXCAVATION SERVICES

CODE OF SAFE PRACTICES

Safe-Ex Inc. | Chapter 4 of the Health and Safety Manual, issued as a standalone posting | v1.2, Effective October 1, 2026 | Revised October 15, 2026

This Code is posted at each job location and reviewed at orientation and in regular safety meetings. It states minimum requirements; the Health and Safety Manual and the pre-task plan govern the details of each task.

GENERAL SAFE PRACTICES

1. All work is performed under this Code, the Health and Safety Manual, and the pre-task plan (JHA) for the task. The plan names the heaviest or most repetitive manual handling, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates. When the work changes, the plan changes first.

2. Every employee has the authority and the duty to stop any work they believe is unsafe. No employee will be disciplined for a good-faith stop or report.

3. Report every injury, near miss, and instance of property, equipment, or utility damage to your supervisor before the end of the shift.

4. Report to work fit for duty: free of impairment from alcohol, drugs, medications that impair, and fatigue. Disclose impairing medications before the shift.

5. Required PPE is worn in all designated areas: hard hat, safety glasses, high-visibility apparel, safety-toe boots, and gloves suited to the task, plus task-specific PPE per the plan.

6. Horseplay, fighting, and pranks are prohibited on all work premises.

7. Keep work areas clean as the work proceeds: walkways clear, cords and hoses out of paths, nails removed or bent, materials stacked stable, spills cleaned or guarded immediately.

8. Inspect tools and equipment before use. Defective tools and equipment are tagged out of service and turned in, never used carefully.

9. Machine guards and safety devices stay in place and functional. Removing or defeating a guard is a serious violation.

10. Cord-connected tools operate on GFCI protection. Damaged cords are removed from service; grounding pins are never removed.

11. Ladders are inspected before use, set on firm level footing, and climbed with three points of contact facing the ladder. Consider a lift or scaffold before choosing a ladder.

12. Use mechanical means or a lifting aid first: forklift, dolly, cart, hoist, or the aid named in the plan. One person lifts no more than 50 pounds alone under good conditions; 50 to 100 pounds is a team lift or mechanical; over 100 pounds is mechanical, always. Keep loads close and turn with the feet, not the back. Rotate high-repetition and high-vibration tasks where the work allows. Report aches, pain, numbness, tingling, or loss of grip to your supervisor the same day; reporting is never disciplined.

13. Never dry-cut, dry-grind, or dry-sweep concrete, masonry, or asphalt. Use water or vacuum dust controls, always.

14. Wear hearing protection in posted areas and around high-noise equipment.

15. Follow the heat illness prevention program: drink water throughout the shift, use shade, take cool-down rests when needed, and watch coworkers for symptoms.

16. Know the emergency plan for your location: alarm, muster point, and who calls 911. Never move a seriously injured person except to prevent further injury, and never drive yourself for treatment of a serious injury.

17. Seatbelts are worn in every vehicle and every machine so equipped. Handheld phone use while operating is prohibited. A spotter is required whenever backing or offloading where any person could be in the path or vision is limited. Working alone, a documented walk-around immediately before the move is the accepted alternative.

18. Only trained and authorized employees operate equipment, machinery, or vehicles, or perform work requiring certification.

EXCAVATION AND UNDERGROUND UTILITIES

19. No mechanical excavation until utility marks are on the ground and the 811 ticket and client locates are current.

20. Within the tolerance zone of a marked utility, expose the line with hand tools or vacuum excavation only, until the line is positively visually verified.

21. Any unidentified line, or any line not shown on marks or plans, stops all excavation in the area until identified.

22. Any contact with a utility, including coating damage, is reported immediately. Damaged gas lines require immediate upwind evacuation and 911.

HYDROVAC OPERATIONS

23. The wand is never directed at a person; hands stay clear of the vacuum inlet while the system operates.

24. Wear hearing protection at the truck, face shield for wand work, and fluid-resistant gloves and boots for spoils.

25. Gas monitoring is used where required; an alarm requires immediate withdrawal and ventilation.

26. Excavation and trench rules apply to every hole created.

TRENCHES

27. No entry into an excavation 5 feet or deeper without a protective system and a competent person inspection that shift and after any change.

28. A ladder or ramp is within 25 feet of every worker in the trench. Spoils and equipment are kept at least 2 feet from the edge.

29. Water accumulation, wall cracks, or ground movement requires immediate exit.

30. Never work under a suspended load or bucket; never ride equipment or the bucket.

HEAVY EQUIPMENT

31. Make positive contact (eye contact or radio acknowledgment) with the operator before approaching any operating machine.

32. Stay out of swing radii and travel paths. Backing equipment operates with a spotter whenever any person could be in the path or vision is limited; working alone, a documented walk-around immediately before the move.

33. Operators wear the seatbelt with the ROPS, complete the daily inspection, and confirm personnel are clear before moving, swinging, or raising.

34. No one passes or works under a raised load, bucket, or bed. Attachments are lowered and de-energized before work near them.

WORK NEAR LIVE TRAFFIC

35. Never step into a live traffic lane outside established traffic control.

36. Wear Class 2 high-visibility apparel minimum; Class 3 at night. Face traffic when the task allows; when it does not, another person watches.

37. Position vehicles as protection between traffic and the work where practical, and identify the escape route before starting.

38. Work requiring more than a brief shoulder stop requires devices or a closure per the CA MUTCD, arranged through supervision.

CONFINED SPACES

39. No entry into any manhole, vault, tank, or other confined space without a permit, atmospheric testing, an attendant, and retrieval equipment.

40. Never enter a space to rescue a downed person. Sound the alarm and call 911.

Stop work authority applies to every rule above. Questions, hazards, and anonymous reports: Corporate Safety, Sergio Robles, 626-366-2912.